

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Is it too late to save our environment?



Learning Outcome

Describe environmental change in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you consider yourself to be environmentally aware? Why or why not?
- In your opinion, what are some of the world's biggest environmental problems?

Can Do Statements

- I can describe environmental problems.
- I can talk about things that are happening.
- I can talk about things that have happened.

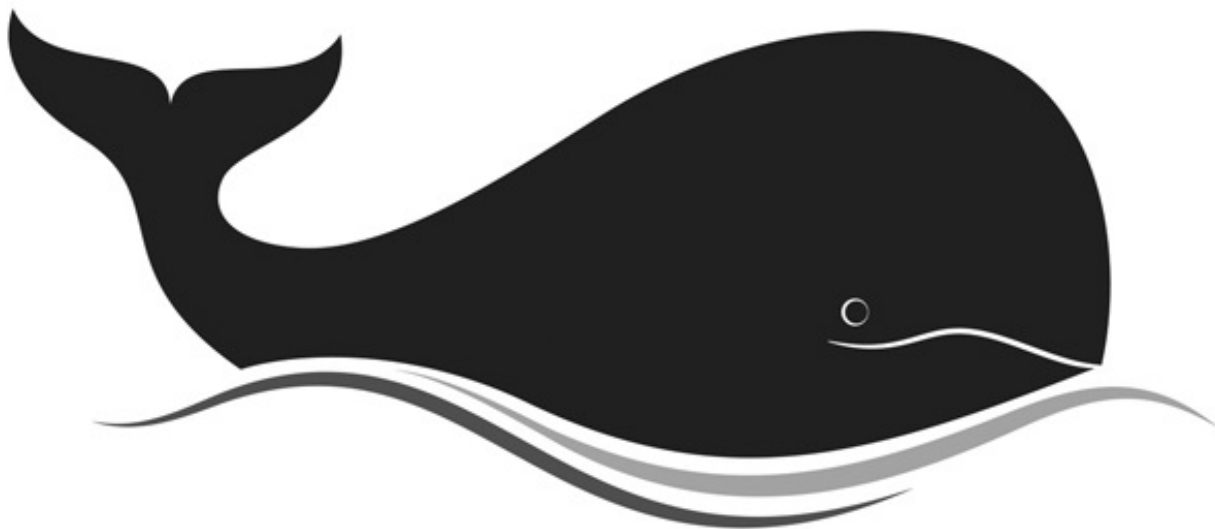




Let's Explore!

How are **wildlife preservation groups*** trying to help?

* "Wildlife preservation groups" are groups that try to help and protect animals from extinction.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Our environment is everything around us. It's the air we breathe, the water we drink, and the earth we leave for future generations. But what is humankind doing to the environment? One of the biggest problems today is pollution. Our air has been made unfit to breathe in many big cities by cars, trucks, and factory emissions. But that's not all. Toxic waste is being poured into our lakes and rivers, ruining the clean water.

Garbage is another serious environmental problem. As the population grows, it has become almost impossible to deal with the amount of garbage that is being created. Piles of garbage now litter some of the most beautiful nature sites. Human actions do not only affect human lives, they also impact the lives of wildlife. Oil spills have caused thousands of ducks and other animals to die from contamination in the water. Although wildlife preservation groups try to clean the birds, only some of them are making it back to the sea alive.

Hunting has also put many species of animals in danger. Animals like the panda, the whale, and the elephant have all been put at risk of becoming extinct. Laws against hunting can save these animals. It is not too late to save our environment. We can only hope that awareness can help us limit the damage we do. We'll then be able to leave a cleaner and healthier environment to future generations.





Let's Practice!

What is being done to the environment?

Instructions: Match the sentences on the right with their missing part. Practice saying the sentences aloud with a partner. Correct each other's pronunciation.

COLUMN A

1. Toxic waste is being poured into
2. As the population grows, it is almost impossible
3. But what is
4. Although wildlife preservation groups try to clean the birds,

COLUMN B

- a. only some of them are making it back to the sea alive.
- b. humankind doing to the environment?
- c. to deal with the amount of garbage that is being created.
- d. our lakes and rivers, ruining the clean water.



Let's Practice!

It is not too late to save our environment.

Instructions: Complete the text below by choosing from the options you are given.

Word Bank

garbage that has created / animals have killed / air is made / garbage that has been created / have all been put at risk / has been made unfit / animals have been killed

1. Our air _____ to breathe in many big cities by cars, trucks, and factory emissions.
2. As the population grows, it has become almost impossible to deal with the amount of _____.
3. Ducks and other _____ by oil spills and contamination in the water.
4. Animals like the panda, the whale, and the elephant _____ of becoming extinct.





Extension Activity

Take a survey.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Ask 4 or 5 friends the following questions:
- What do you consider is the most serious environmental issue? Why?
- What do you do to help the planet?
- Don't forget to take notes of their answers.
- Prepare a written summary of the answers. Use the passive in your writing.
- Share your summary with other classmates.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I take a survey about environmental issues.

☐ ☐

I write a summary of the survey results.

☐ ☐

I share my summary with others.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- unfit** (adjective): not good enough to do or to be used
e.g. Our air has been made unfit to breathe.
- factory** (noun): a building where goods are produced in large quantities, by machines
e.g. Our air has been made unfit to breathe because of cars, trucks, and factory emissions.
- emissions** (noun): a gas or other substance sent into the air
e.g. Factory emissions cause problems in air quality.
- toxic waste** (noun): a harmful substance which causes health problems and negatively affects the environment
e.g. Toxic waste is being poured into our lakes and rivers, ruining the clean water.
- pile** (noun): a heap; a mass
e.g. Piles of garbage now litter some of the most beautiful nature sites.
- to litter** (verb): to throw garbage or waste on the ground
e.g. Piles of garbage litter some of the most beautiful nature sites.
- oil spill** (noun): crude oil released into a body of water
e.g. Oil spills have caused thousands of ducks and other animals to die.
- contamination** (noun): pollution by a poisonous or hazardous substance
e.g. Thousands of ducks and other animals die from contamination in the water.
- hunting** (noun): chasing and killing animals for food or sport
e.g. Hunting has also put many species of animals in danger.
- awareness** (noun): perception; understanding
e.g. We can only hope that awareness can help us limit the damage we do.





Learning Points

The Present Continuous Tense: Passive and Active Forms

You use the **Present Continuous** to talk about an action that is happening at the time of speaking. The action or event is in progress.

You can use the **Present Continuous** in both active and passive structures.

Active:

*People (subject) **are pouring** toxic waste (object) into our lakes and rivers, ruining the clean water.*

Passive:

*Toxic waste (subject) **is being poured** into our lakes and rivers, ruining the clean water (by people).*

You often choose the passive form when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in academic and scientific writing. In the example above, *people* is the agent.

Look at the chart below to see the form of the **Present Continuous** passive:

Subject	is/was/were	being	past participle
<i>Toxic waste</i>	<i>is</i>	<i>being</i>	<i>poured.</i>
<i>The amount of garbage that</i>	<i>is</i>	<i>being</i>	<i>created.</i>

Examples:

- *But what is humankind doing to the environment?*
- *Toxic waste is being poured into our lakes and rivers, ruining the clean water.*
- *As the population grows, it has become almost impossible to deal with the amount of garbage that is being created.*
- *Although wildlife preservation groups try to clean the birds, only some of them are making it back to the sea alive.*





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense: Active and Passive Forms

You use the Present Perfect to talk about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present.

You can use the Present Perfect passive to talk about the same kind of actions or events. The passive shifts the focus from the doer of the action (*agent*) to the receiver of the action.

Example:

*Our air **has been made** unfit to breathe in many big cities by cars, trucks, and factory emissions.*

In this example, the agent is cars, trucks and factory emissions. In a passive clause, you usually use *by* to introduce the agent. Agents are not used often in passive clauses.

Look at the chart below to see the form of the Present Perfect passive:

Subject	has/have	been	past participle
<i>Our air</i>	<i>has</i>	<i>been</i>	<i>made ...</i>
<i>Elephants and whales</i>	<i>have</i>	<i>been</i>	<i>put ...</i>

Examples:

- *Our air has been made unfit to breathe in many big cities by cars, trucks, and factory emissions.*
- *As the population grows, it has become almost impossible to deal with the amount of garbage that is being created.*
- *Oil spills have caused thousands of ducks and other animals to die from contamination in the water.*
- *Hunting has also put many species of animals in danger.*
- *Animals like the panda, the whale, and the elephant have all been put at risk of becoming extinct.*

